ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 31

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

# My First Malay Jawi Alphabet

## حروف جاوي ڤرتام واي

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 37 Jawi Letters of Malay with English Phonetics

ا ب ت چ ڠ ڤ

**Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza**

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

**Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah**

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

**REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication**

**REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET.** The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

**My First Malay Jawi Alphabet** — حروف جاوي ڤرتام ساي

Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 31

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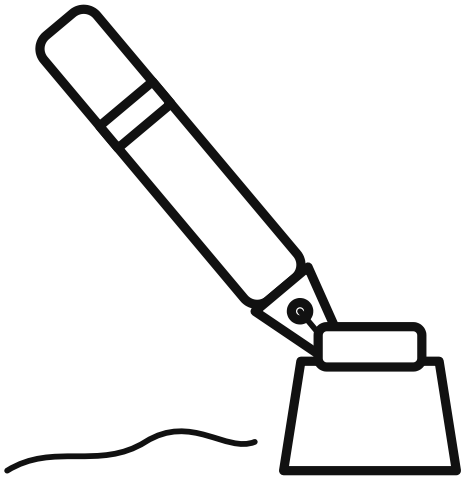
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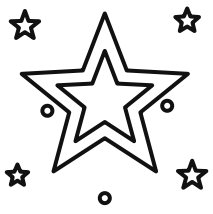
**A note of respect:** this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



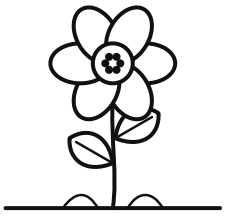
# This book belongs to

## بوکو این میلیق

I started learning Malay on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

# The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

*ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"*

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

*Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.*

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

**Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4**[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

**What does *al-bayān* mean?** It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

# Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

*Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.*

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

**Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22**[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

*Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.*

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

**Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)**[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

### How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

**Book 31 is Malay**. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

# How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

**Marker tip:** every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

### Reading the English sound guides

- **Jawi is read from right to left**, like the Qur'an. The tracing rows on each page also start on the right.
- **The line under each word is its Rumi spelling** — Malay in Latin letters. Rumi is easy to read aloud: *a* as in "father", *i* as in "see", *u* as in "put", and *e* is usually a short 'uh' (as in "about").
- In Rumi, **c** says 'ch' (*cawan* = "chah-wan"), **sy** says 'sh', **ng** is the sound in "sing" and **ny** is the sound in "canyon".
- **Some letters sound the same** in Malay (ص س ث all say *s*; ظ ز ذ all say *z*). They keep their Arabic spelling, which helps when children later read the Qur'an.

### Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Malay name** written in Malay (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. Because Jawi letters **change shape** when they join, the third box shows the letter at the start, middle and end of a word (letters that never join to the next letter are marked).

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow standard Malay as written in Malaysia and Brunei.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

# Hello, Malay! بهاس ملايو

*bahasa Melayu — the Malay word for the language*

**Who speaks it?**
About **80 million people** speak Malay as a first or second language, and Indonesian, a form of Malay, is spoken by many millions more.[3]

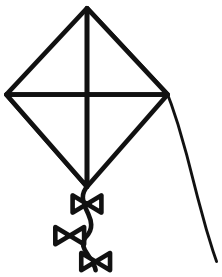
**Where?**
In **Malaysia**, **Brunei**, **Singapore** and **southern Thailand**, and by families around the world.

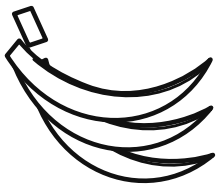
**How is it written?**
Malay has two scripts: **Rumi** (Latin letters) and **Jawi**, an Arabic-based script written from **right to left**. Jawi has been used for Malay for hundreds of years.

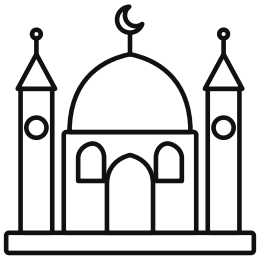
**How many letters?**
This book teaches **37 Jawi letters**: the Arabic letters plus six made for Malay sounds — چ غ ڤ ک ۏ ڽ.

**Where can you see Jawi?**
On mosques, school books and religious lessons, on street signs in some states, and in Brunei, where Jawi is written alongside Rumi.

**A friend of the Qur'an**
Many Malay words come from Arabic: مسجد *masjid* (mosque), علمو *ilmu* (knowledge). Knowing Jawi helps with reading the Qur'an.







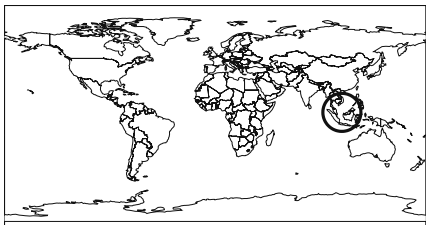
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

# The Malay Alphabet حروف جاوي

## 37 letters – حروف جاوي

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ح *ḥa* | ج *jim* | ث *sa* | ة *ta marbutah* | ت *ta* | ب *ba* | ا *alif* |
| س *sin* | ز *zai* | ر *ra* | ذ *zal* | د *dal* | خ *kha* | چ *ca* |
| غ *ghain* | ع *ain* | ظ *ẓa* | ط *ṭa* | ض *dad* | ص *sad* | ش *syin* |
| ل *lam* | ک *ga* | ک *kaf* | ق *qaf* | ڤ *pa* | ف *fa* | ڠ *nga* |
| ي *ya* | ء *hamzah* | ه *ha* | ۏ *va* | و *wau* | ن *nun* | م *mim* |
| | | | | | ڽ *nya* | ى *alif maksurah* |

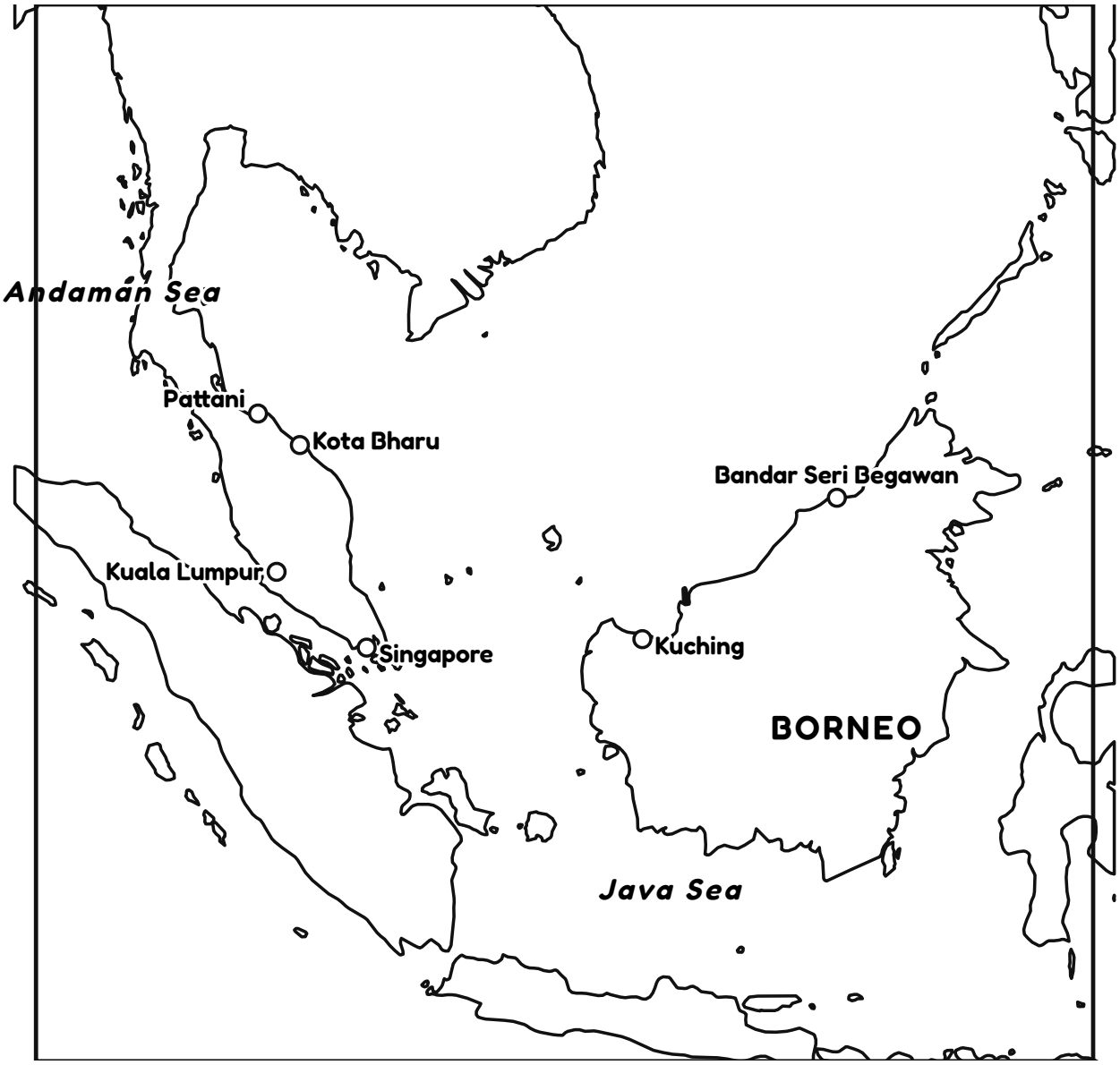
Read the alphabet from **right to left**, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows Malaysia, Brunei and Singapore on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

# Where is Malay spoken?




**Color it:** the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Malay is spoken in Kuala Lumpur and Kota Bharu (Malaysia), Kuching on the island of Borneo, Bandar Seri Begawan (Brunei), Singapore and Pattani (southern Thailand).

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# The Letters حروف جاوي

*huruf Jawi — "the Jawi letters"*

Jawi is written **from right to left**. Open your book at any letter page and start reading on the right!

**Arabic letters, plus six more**

Jawi uses the Arabic letters and adds six of its own for Malay sounds:

| ث | ڤ | ڠ | ک | ۏ | چ |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *ny* | *v* | *g* | *p* | *ng* | *c* |

**Letters hold hands**

Most letters **join** to the letter after them and change shape a little:

ب + و + ل + ن = بولن

*b + u + l + n = bulan* (moon)

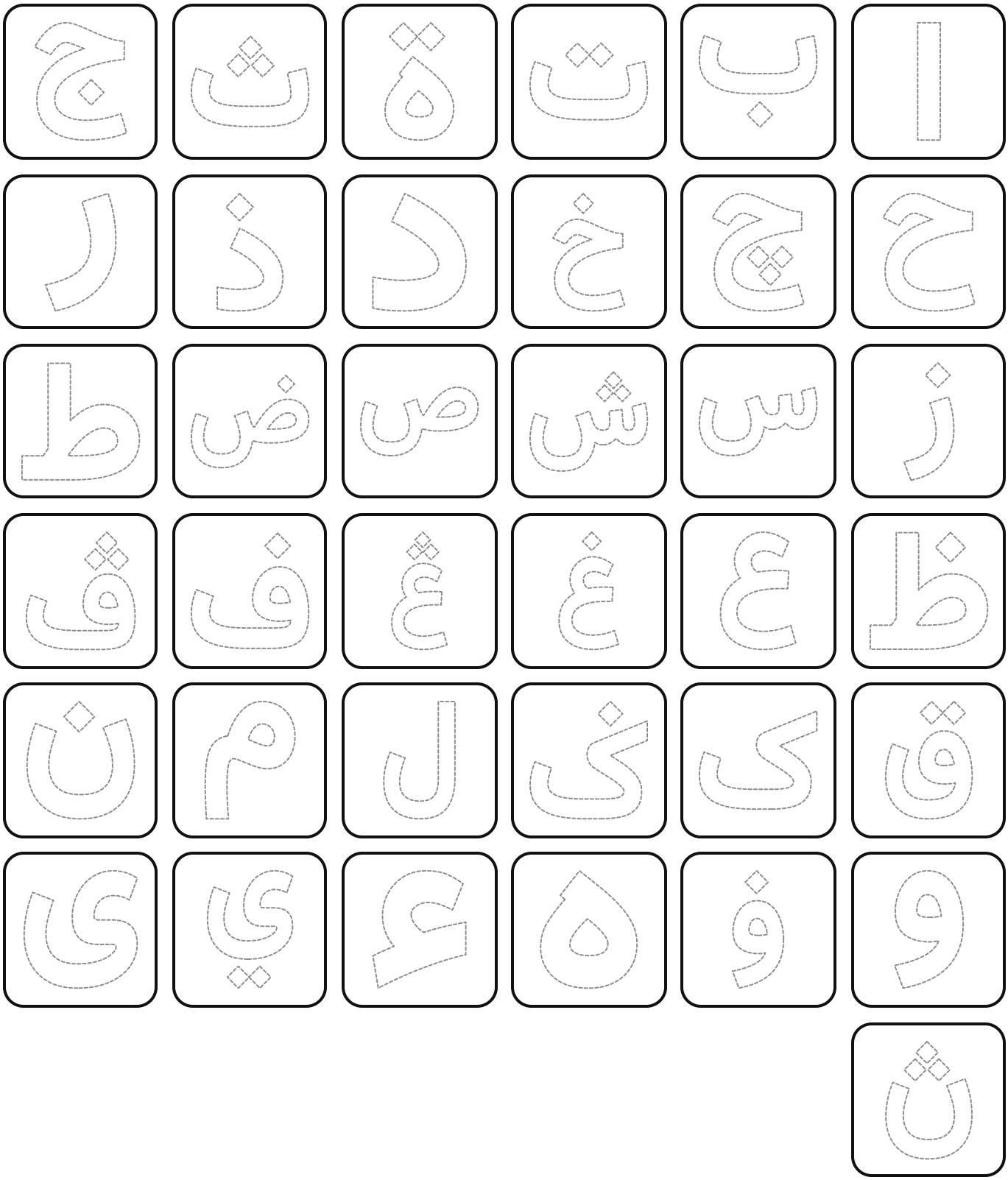
**Two ways to write Malay**

Malay is also written in Latin letters, called **Rumi**. Under every Jawi word in this book you will find its Rumi spelling: بولن = *bulan*.

PENCIL WARM-UP

# Trace the letters حروف جاوي

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ا

**NAME · نام**

# اليف

*alif*

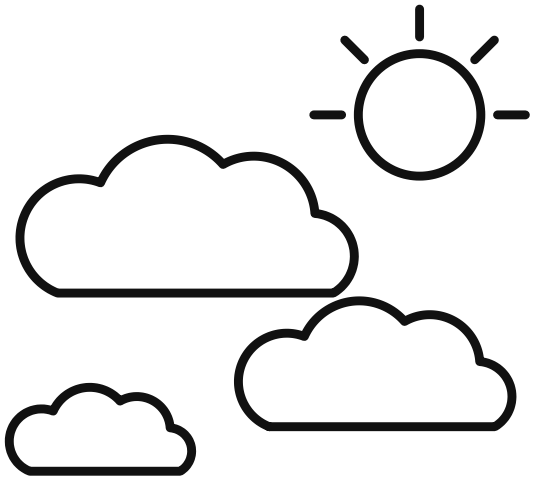
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘a’ as in “father”; at the start of a word it can also carry ‘e’, ‘i’ or ‘u’

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

Alone ا · after a letter ـا

It never joins to the letter after it.



**ا IS FOR**

# اون

*awan*

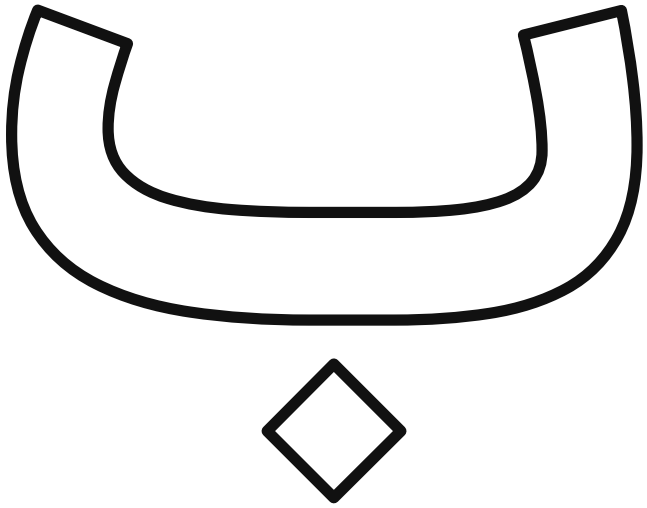
**cloud**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

ا ا ا ا ا ا

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**NAME · نام**

# با

*ba*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘b’ as in “ball”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

بـ ـبـ ـب

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

One dot below.



**ب IS FOR**

# بولن

*bulan*

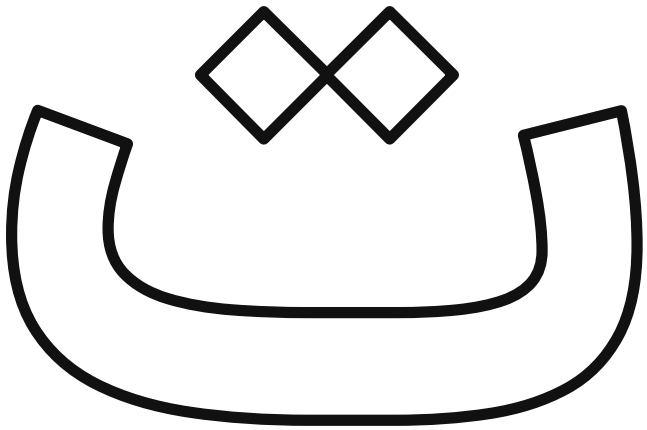
**moon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ب ب ب ب

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**NAME · نام**

# تا

*ta*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

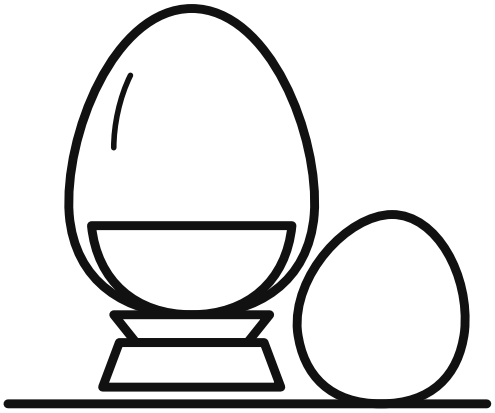
‘t’ as in “top”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

تـ ـتـ ـت

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Two dots above.



**ت IS FOR**

# تلور

*telur*

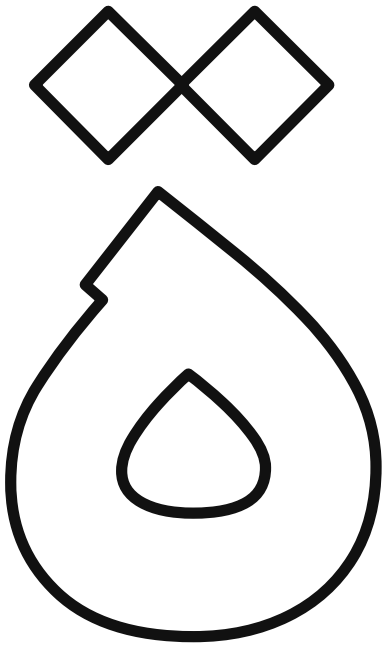
**egg**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

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**NAME · نام**

# تا مربوطة

*ta marbutah*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

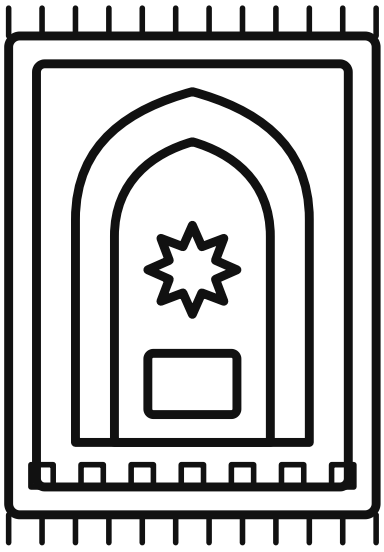
't' (or 'h') — only at the end of words from Arabic

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

End of a word: ة · after a joining letter ـة

It is only found at the end of a word.

Find ة at the end of صلاة!



**ة IS FOR**

# صلاة

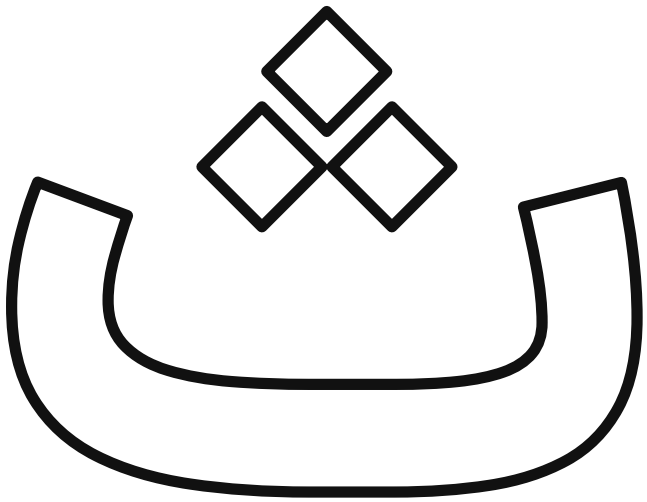
*solat*

**prayer (salah)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

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**NAME · نام**

# ث ا س

*sa*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

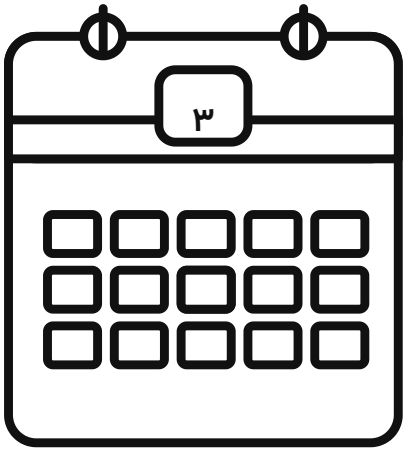
‘s’ as in “sun”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

ثـ ـثـ ـث

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.




**ث IS FOR**

# ثلاث

*Selasa*

**Tuesday — the third day of the week**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ث ث ث ث

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ج

**NAME · نام**

جيم

*jim*

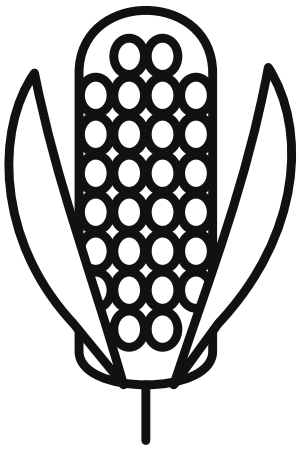
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'j' as in "jam"

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

جـ ـجـ ـج

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**ج IS FOR**

# جاگوڠ

*jagung*

**corn (maize)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ج ج ج ج

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ح

**NAME · نام**

حا

*ḥa*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

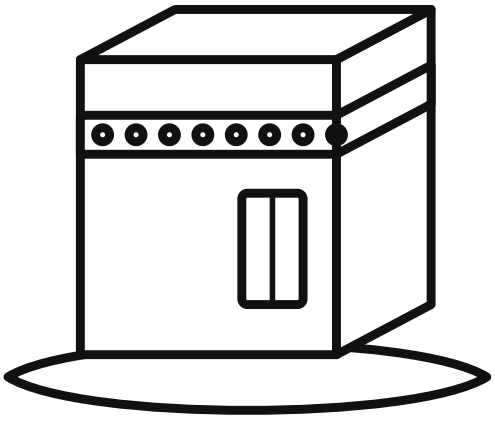
a strong breathy ‘h’ from the middle of the throat

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

حـ ـحـ ـح

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



**ح IS FOR**

# حاجي

*haji*

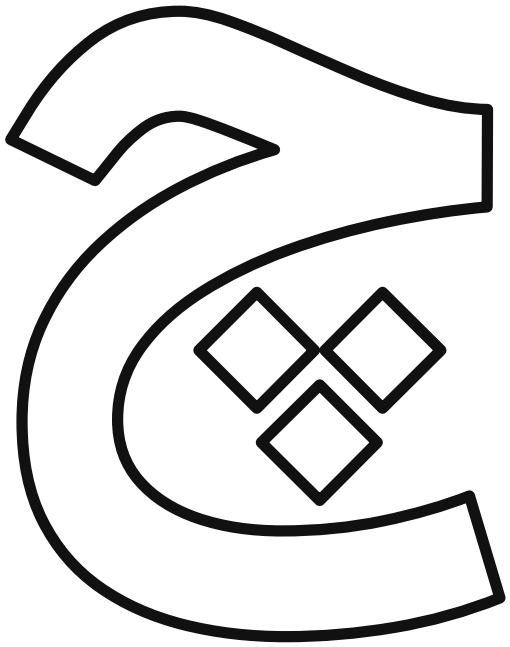
## Hajj, the journey to the Kaaba in Makkah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ح ح ح ح

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**NAME · نام**

# چا

*ca*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ch’ as in “chair” — written **c** in Rumi

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

چ ـچـ ـچ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A special Jawi letter.



**چ IS FOR**

# چاون

*cawan*

**cup**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

چ چ چ

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خ

**NAME · نام**

خا

*kha*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

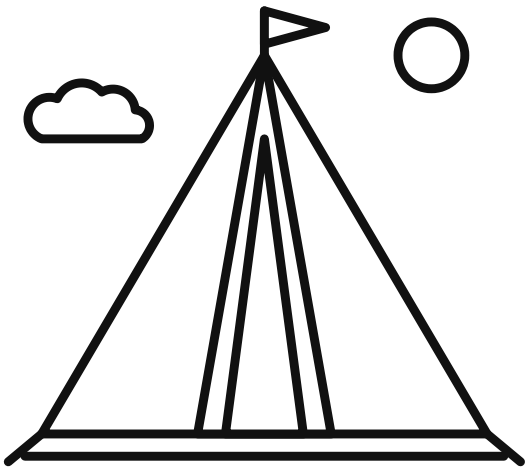
a scratchy ‘kh’ from the back of the throat, as in Scottish “loch”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

خـ ـخـ ـخ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



**خ IS FOR**

# خيمه

*khemah*

**tent**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

خ خ خ خ

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د

**NAME · نام**

دال

*dal*

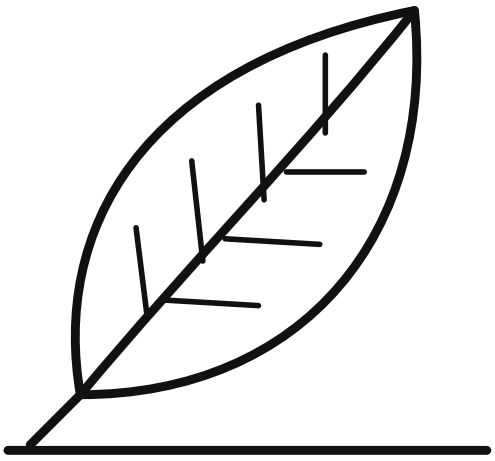
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘d’ as in “dog”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

Alone د · after a letter ـد

It never joins to the letter after it.



**د IS FOR**

# داون

*daun*

**leaf**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

د د د

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ذ

**NAME · نام**

# ذال

*zal*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

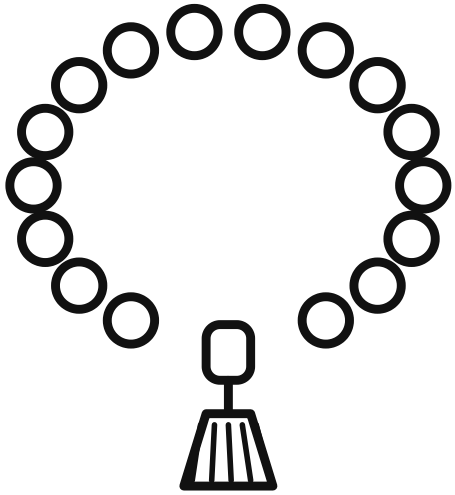
‘z’ as in “zoo”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

Alone ذ · after a letter ـذ

It never joins to the letter after it.

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



**ذ IS FOR**

# ذكير

*zikir*

**dhikr — remembering Allah**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

ذ ذ ذ ذ

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ر

**NAME · نام**

را

*ra*

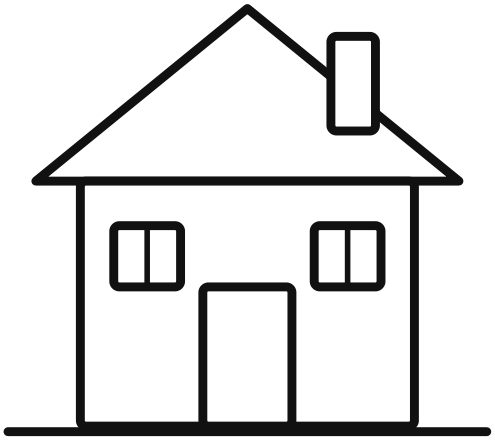
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a rolled or tapped ‘r’

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

Alone ر · after a letter ـر

It never joins to the letter after it.



**ر IS FOR**

# رومه

*rumah*

**house**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ر ر ر ر

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ز

**NAME · نام**

# زاي

*zai*

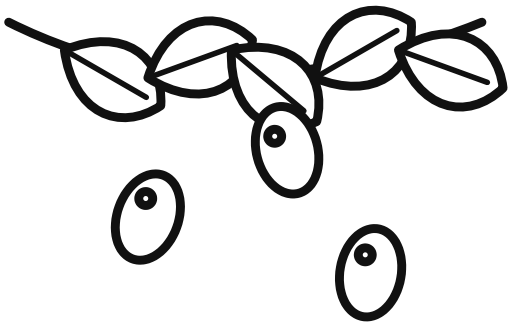
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘z’ as in “zoo”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

Alone **ز** · after a letter **ـز**

It never joins to the letter after it.



**ز IS FOR**

# زيتون

*zaitun*

**olives**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

ز ز ز ز

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س

**NAME · نام**

**سين**

*sin*

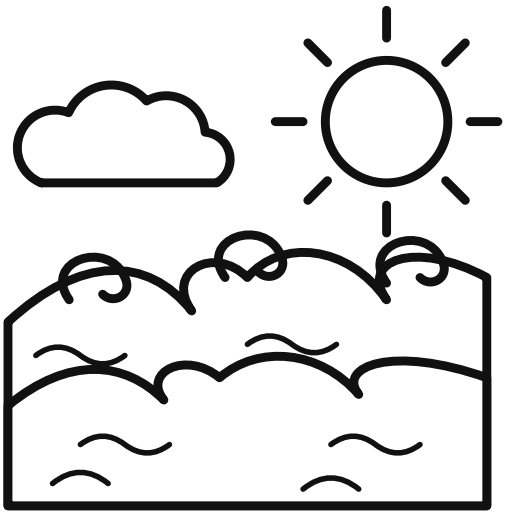
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

's' as in "sun"

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

سـ ـسـ ـس

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**س IS FOR**

# سوڠاي

*sungai*

**river**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

س س س س س

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ش

**NAME · نام**

**شين**

*syin*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘sh’ as in “shoe” — written **sy** in Rumi

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

شـ ـشـ ـش

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**ش IS FOR**

# شوال

*Syawal*

**Syawal, the month of Eid (Hari Raya)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ش ش ش ش

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# ص

**NAME · نام**

## صاد

*sad*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

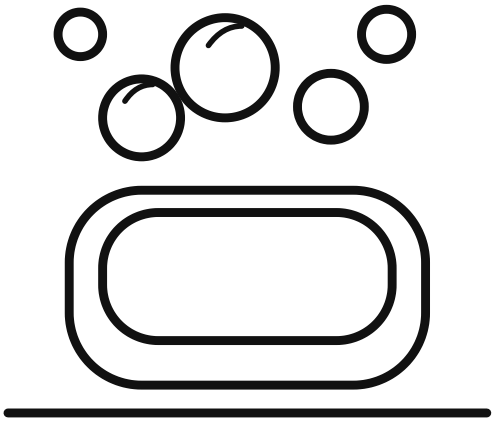
‘s’ as in “sun”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

صـ ـصـ ـص

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



**ص IS FOR**

## صابون

*sabun*

**soap**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ص ص ص ص

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# ض

**NAME · نام**

## ضاد

*dad*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘d’ as in “dog” (in Arabic, a heavy ‘ḍ’)

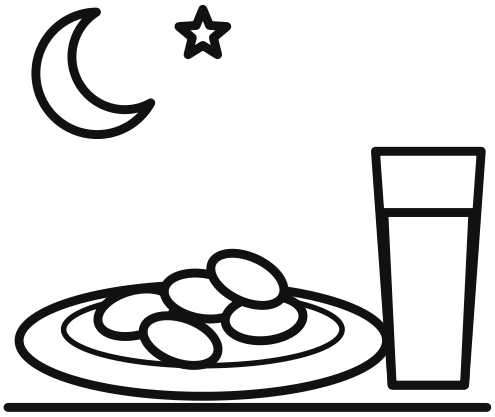
**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

ضـ ـضـ ـض

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.

Find ض near the end of رمضان.



**ض IS FOR**

## رمضان

*Ramadan*

**Ramadan, the month of fasting**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ض ض ض ض ض

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ط

**NAME · نام**

طا

*ṭa*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘t’ as in “top” (in Arabic, a heavy ‘ṭ’)

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

ـط ـطـ طـ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.

**ط IS FOR**



# طهارة

*taharah*

**taharah — washing to be clean for prayer**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ط ط ط

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ظ

**NAME · نام**

ظا

*ẓa*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

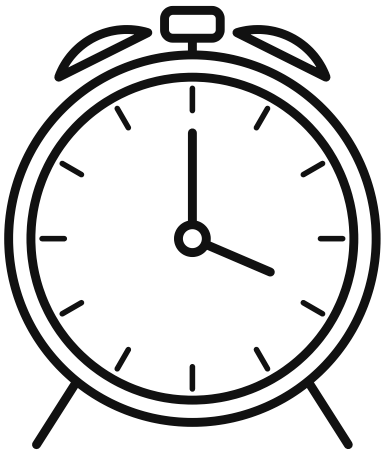
‘z’ as in “zoo” (in Arabic, a heavy ‘ẓ’)

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

ظ ـظ ـظـ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.



**ظ IS FOR**

## ظهر

*Zohor*

**Zuhr — the time of the midday prayer**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ظ ظ ظ ظ

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ع

**NAME · نام**

**عين**

*ain*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

in Malay, just the vowel next to it — in Arabic, a sound from deep in the throat

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

عـ ـعـ ـع

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.




**ع IS FOR**

# علمو

*ilmu*

**knowledge, learning**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ع ع ع ع

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غ

**NAME · نام**

غين

*ghain*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a soft gargled ‘gh’ from the back of the throat

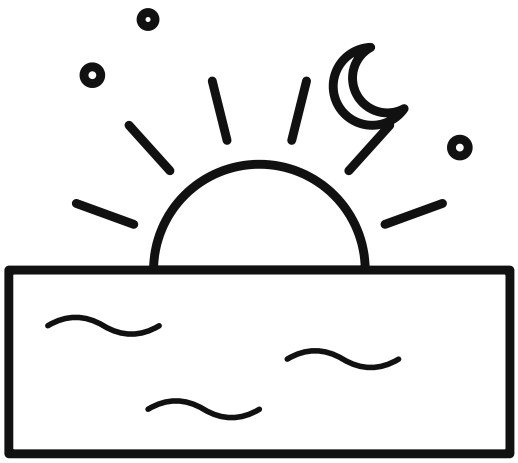
**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

غـ ـغـ ـغ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Used mostly in words that come from Arabic.

Find غ in the middle of مغرب.



**غ IS FOR**

# مغرب

*Maghrib*

**sunset — the time of the evening prayer**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

غ غ غ غ

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ڠ

**NAME · نام**

**ڠا**

*nga*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ng’ as in “sing” — written **ng** in Rumi

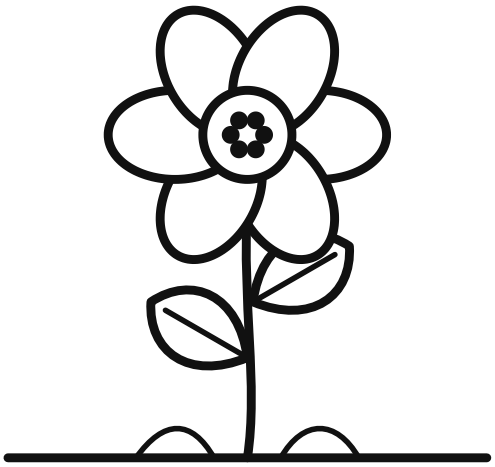
**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

**ڠ ـڠـ ـڠ**

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A special Jawi letter. ع with three dots.

Find ڠ in the middle of بوڠا!



**ڠ IS FOR**

# بوڠا

*bunga*

**flower**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ڠ ڠ ڠ ڠ

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ف

**NAME · نام**

**فا**

*fa*

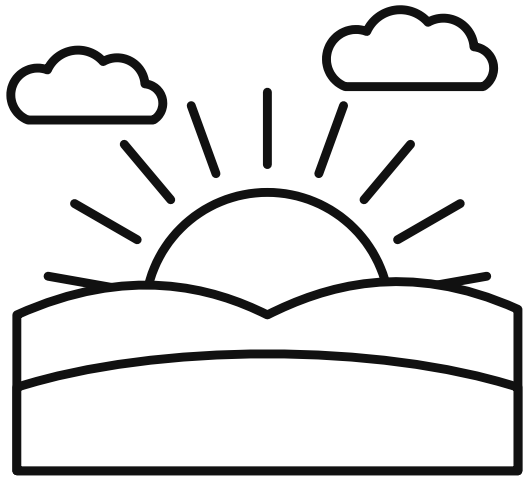
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘f’ as in “fan”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

**فـ ـفـ ـف**

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**ف IS FOR**

# فجر

*fajar*

**dawn**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ف ف ف ف

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ڤ

**NAME · نام**

ڤا

*pa*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

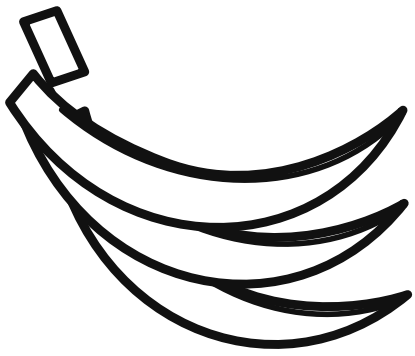
‘p’ as in “pen”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

ڤ ـڤـ ـڤ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A special Jawi letter. ف with three dots.



**ڤ IS FOR**

# ڤيسڠ

*pisang*

**banana**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

ڤ ڤ ڤ ڤ ڤ

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ق

**NAME · نام**

# قاف

*qaf*

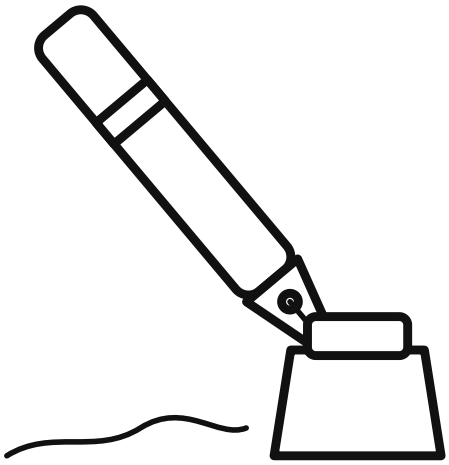
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘k’ said far back in the throat (in Malay, often just ‘k’)

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

قـ ـقـ ـق

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**ق IS FOR**

# قلم

*kalam*

**pen**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ق ق ق ق

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ک

**NAME · نام**

# كاف

*kaf*

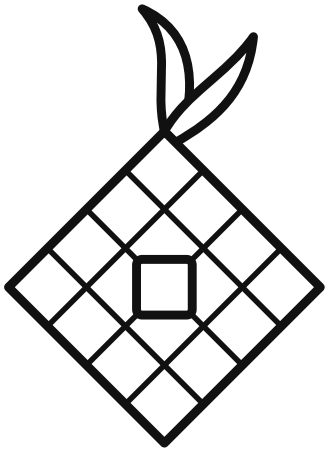
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘k’ as in “kite”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

ک ـکـ ـک

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**ک IS FOR**

# كتوڤت

*ketupat*

**ketupat — rice cooked in a woven palm-leaf case for Hari Raya**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ک ک ک ک

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ڬ

**NAME · نام**

ڬا

*ga*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

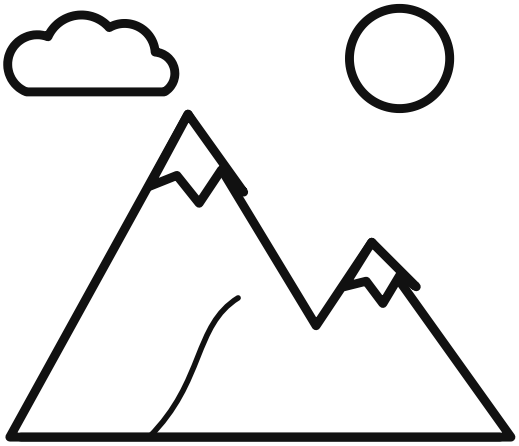
‘g’ as in “go”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

ڬ ـڬـ ـڬ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A special Jawi letter. One dot above ک.



**ڬ IS FOR**

# ڬونوڠ

*gunung*

**mountain**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ڬ ڬ ڬ ڬ

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ل

**NAME · نام**

لام

*lam*

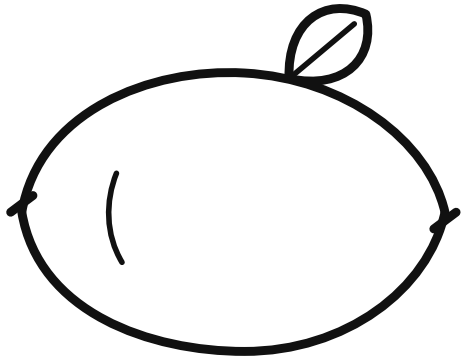
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'l' as in "lamp"

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

ل ـلـ ـل

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**ل IS FOR**

# ليماو

*limau*

**lime, citrus fruit**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

ل ل ل ل

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م

**NAME · نام**

# ميم

*mim*

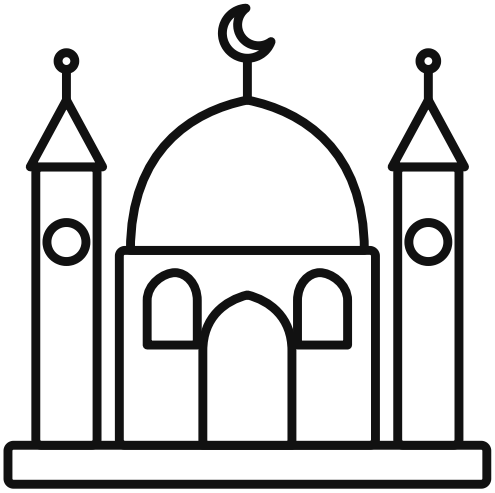
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘m’ as in “moon”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

مـ ـمـ ـم

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**م IS FOR**

## مسجد

*masjid*

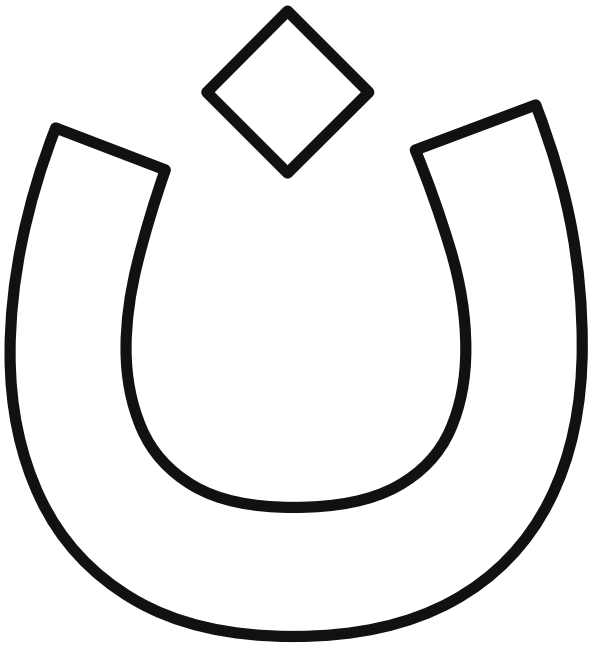
**mosque**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

م م م م

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**NAME · نام**

# نون

*nun*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘n’ as in “net”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

نـ ـنـ ـن

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**ن IS FOR**

# ناسي

*nasi*

**cooked rice**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

ن ن ن ن

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و

**NAME · نام**

واو

*wau*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

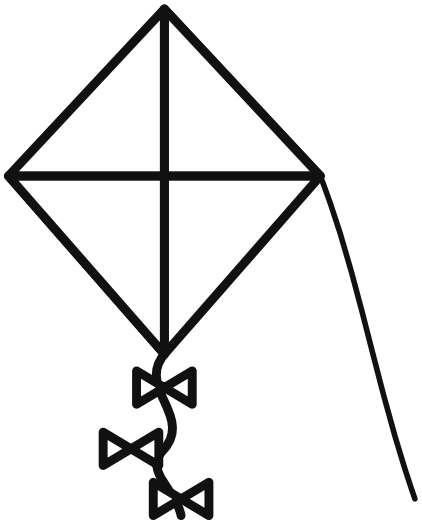
'w' as in "water", or the vowels 'u' and 'o'

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

Alone **و** · after a letter **ـو**

It never joins to the letter after it.

The letter's name and the word sound the same!



**و IS FOR**

# واو

*wau*

**wau — a big Malay kite**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

و و و و

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ڤ

**NAME · نام**

ڤا

*va*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

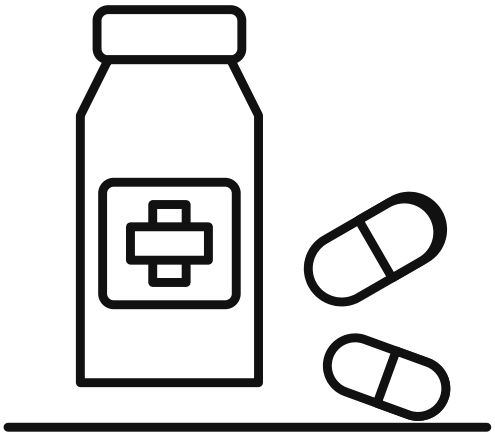
'v' as in "van" — only in borrowed words

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

Alone **ڤ** · after a letter **ـڤ**

It never joins to the letter after it.

A special Jawi letter. One dot above و.



**ڤ IS FOR**

# ڤيتامين

*vitamin*

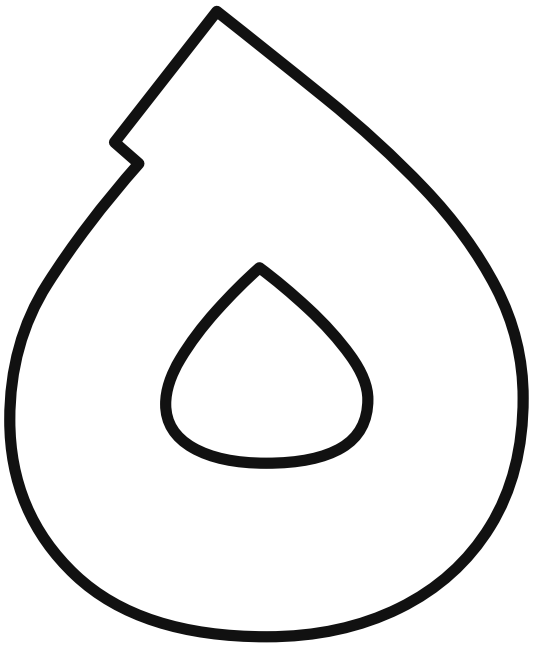
**vitamins**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

ڤ ڤ ڤ ڤ

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**NAME · نام**

# ها

*ha*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘h’ as in “hat”

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

هـ ـهـ ـه

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



**ه IS FOR**

# هوجن

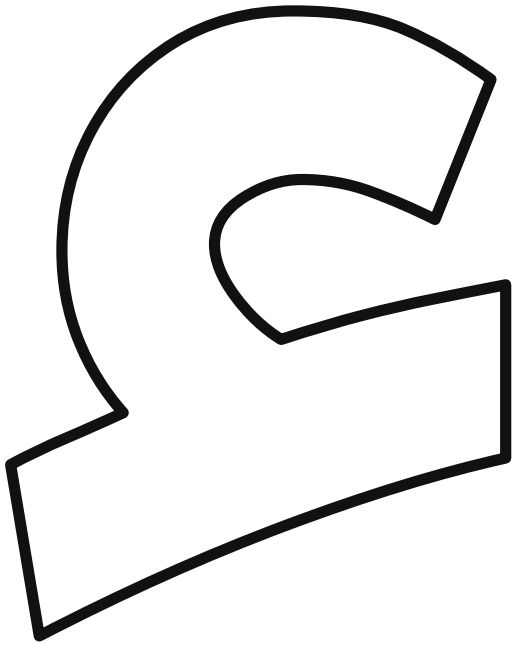
*hujan*

**rain**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

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**NAME · نام**

# همزه

*hamzah*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

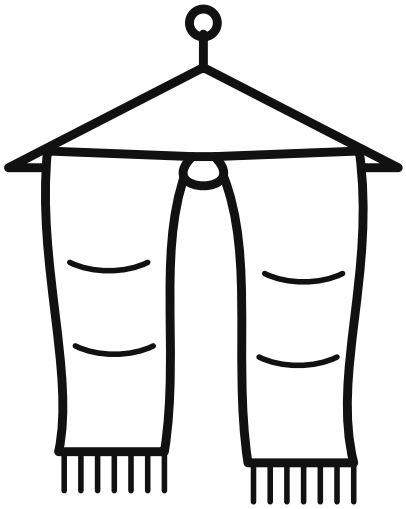
a tiny break in the voice between two vowels

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

Always alone: **ء**

It never joins to any letter. It sits on the line between two vowels.

Find the ء between the two vowels of كاءين *ka-in*.



**ء IS FOR**

# كاءين

*kain*

**cloth**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ء ء ء ء

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ي

**NAME · نام**

**يا**

*ya*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘y’ as in “yes”, or the vowels ‘i’ and ‘e’

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

يـ ـيـ ـي

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Find ي in the middle of ڤايوڠ.



**ي IS FOR**

# ڤايوڠ

*payung*

**umbrella**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

ي ي ي ي

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ى

**NAME · نام**

# اليف مقصورة

*alif maksurah*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'a' — only at the end of some words from Arabic

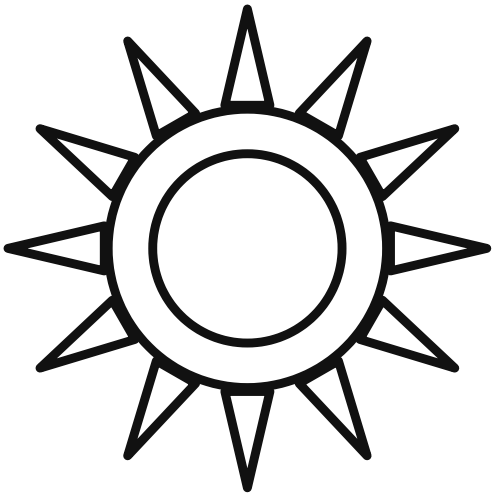
**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

End of a word: **ى** · after a joining letter **ـى**

It is only found at the end of a word.

It looks like ي without its dots.

Find ى at the end of ضحى!



**ى IS FOR**

## ضحى

*Duha*

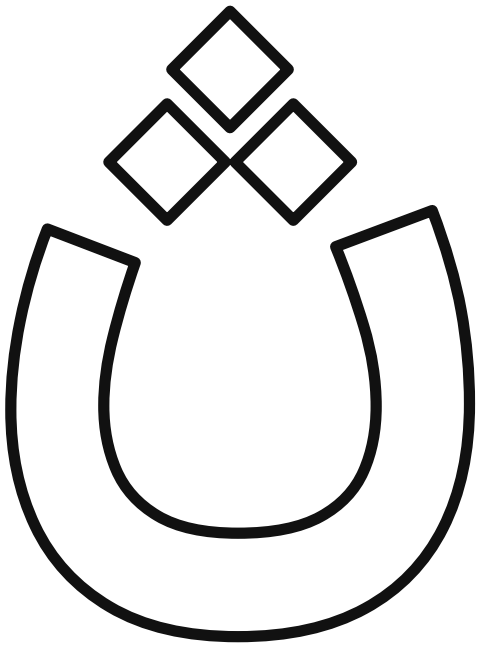
**Duha — the bright late-morning time**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · توليس**

ى ى ى ى

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**NAME · نام**

# ڽا

*nya*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

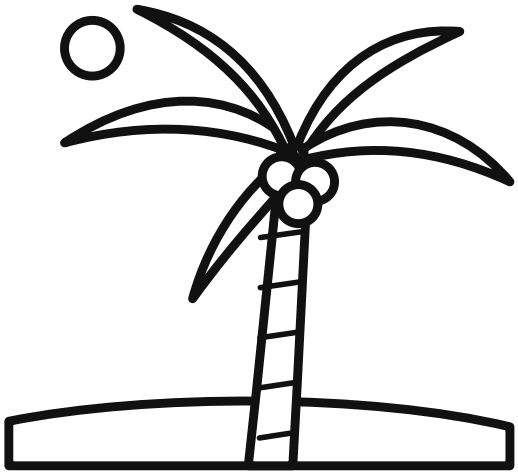
‘ny’ as in “canyon” — written **ny** in Rumi

**LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS**

ڽ ـڽـ ـڽ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A special Jawi letter. Dots above when alone, below when joined.



**ڽ IS FOR**

# ڽيور

*nyiur*

**coconut palm**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · تولیس**

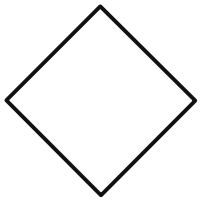
ڽ ڽ ڽ ڽ

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BONUS

# Malay numbers نومبور *(nombor)*

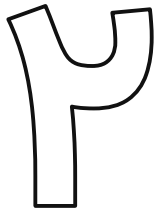
Color the numbers and count out loud in Malay: *sifar*, *satu*, *dua*, *tiga*...



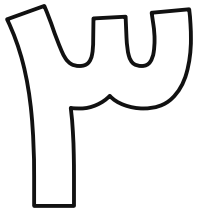
**0**
**سيفر**
*sifar*
zero



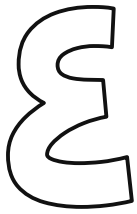
**1**
**ساتو**
*satu*
one



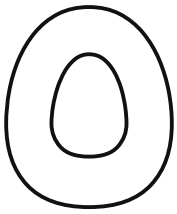
**2**
**دوا**
*dua*
two



**3**
**تيڬ**
*tiga*
three



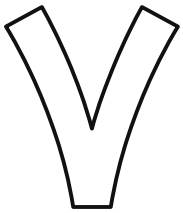
**4**
**امڤت**
*empat*
four



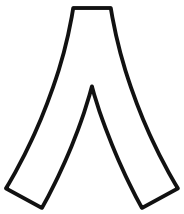
**5**
**ليم**
*lima*
five



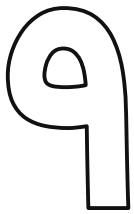
**6**
**انم**
*enam*
six



**7**
**توجوه**
*tujuh*
seven



**8**
**لاڤن**
*lapan*
eight



**9**
**سمبيلن**
*sembilan*
nine

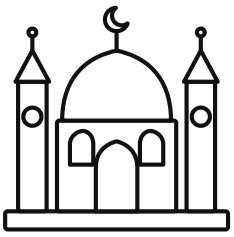
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LET'S TALK

# My first Malay words ڤرکاتاءن ڤرتام

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

| | |
|---|---|
| السلام عليكم | *assalamualaikum*<br>**Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)** |
| وعليكم السلام | *waalaikumussalam*<br>**And upon you be peace (the reply)** |
| نام ساي ... | *nama saya ...*<br>**My name is ...** |
| تريما كاسيه | *terima kasih*<br>**Thank you** |
| جزاک الله خيرا | *jazakallahu khairan*<br>**May Allah reward you with good** |
| ايبو · باڤ | *ibu · bapa*<br>**Mother · Father** |
| ابڠ · كاكق | *abang · kakak*<br>**(Older) brother · (older) sister** |
| ي · تيدق | *ya · tidak*<br>**Yes · No** |
| ساي سدڠ بلاجر بهاس ملايو! | *saya sedang belajar bahasa Melayu!*<br>**I am learning Malay!** |







REFERENCES & SOURCES

# Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

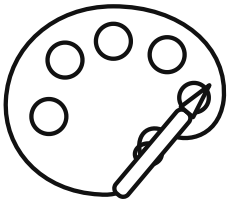
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

**What's next?**
You have met all **37 Malay letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Malay, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

**Enjoyed this book?**
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*





# Certificate of Achievement

## ماشاءالله! باگوس!

*masya-Allah! bagus! — Well done, very good!*

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
**all 37 letters of the Malay alphabet**.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

*Minhaz Reza*

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

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